

FINLAND

Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Finland
Short Form	Finland
Capital	Helsinki
Region (UN)	Western Europe
Government Type	Parliamentary Republic
Head of State	President Alexander Stubb
Head of Government	Prime Minister Petteri Orpo
Currency	Euro (€)
UN Member Since	14 December 1955
MUN Standing	Active advocate of peace, human rights, and sustainable development. Strong EU-aligned stance; known for leadership on education, gender equality, and conflict resolution.

Book Recommendations

Title	Author	Why It's Relevant
<i>Finland in the United Nations</i>	Tapani Brotherus	Detailed history of Finland's evolving UN role and contributions.
<i>The Nordic Model: Scandinavia Since 1945</i>	Mary Hilson	Insight into Finnish social-democratic policy influencing its MUN stances.
<i>Small States in International Relations</i>	Christine Ingebritsen et al.	Helps understand Finland's diplomatic style as a consensus-seeking small state.
<i>Finland's Foreign Policy in the 21st Century</i>	Teija Tiilikainen	Explores modern foreign policy priorities of Finland in a global context.
<i>Gender Equality and Nation Branding in the Nordic Region</i>	Päivi Naskali, Marjaana Niemi	Useful for UNCSW and ECOSOC regarding Finland's gender equality leadership.

Finland: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UN Digital Library – Finland Human Rights Statements	https://digitallibrary.un.org/search?cc=Meetings&f1=author&p1=Finland	Collection of official Finnish submissions at UN human rights events.

Universal Periodic Review – Finland Reports	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/fi-index	Documents Finland's UPR submissions and responses.
UN Treaty Body Database – Finland	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/TBSearch.aspx?Lang=en&CountryID=61	Lists Finland's reports and compliance under major UN human rights treaties.
Human Rights Centre (Oikeuskansleri) – Finland	https://www.humanrightscentre.fi/	Finland's official human rights monitoring and education institution.
Amnesty International – Finland Report	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/finland/report-finland/	Covers domestic human rights issues: asylum, policing, minorities.
Human Rights Watch – Finland Profile	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/finland	Independent reporting on Finland's rights-based issues and international engagement.
Freedom House – Finland Country Report	https://freedomhouse.org/country/finland/freedom-world/2023	Rates Finland's democratic rights, civil liberties, and rule of law.
ECTHR – Finland Case Law	https://hudoc.echr.coe.int/eng#{"respondent":["FIN"]}	Legal proceedings relevant to Finland's human rights obligations.

Title	Link	Relevance
Universal Periodic Review – Finland	OHCHR UPR Central Page	Official UPR documents: reports, recommendations, responses
OHCHR Finland Country Page	OHCHR	Hub for all Finland's UNHRC & treaty body materials

CRC Concluding Observations (5th-6th)	CRC PDF (May 2023)	Children's rights, asylum-seeking minors
UNHCR Refugee Policy Rec (Apr 2023)	UNHCR PDF	Asylum process, non-refoulement
UNHCR Finland Contributions	UNHCR Global Focus	Finland's refugee aid & policy support
Freedom in the World 2024	Freedom House Report 2024	Political/civil freedoms index
Freedom in the World 2025	Freedom House Report 2025	Updated rights status
UNHCR Critical Press Release	UNHCR Europe Press	Warning on asylum restrictions
UPR Adoption Session (Video)	UN Web TV	Live confirmation of recommendations
US State Dept HR Report 2023	State Dept Summary	Ongoing human rights issues overview
US HR Report 2021	US State Report PDF	Detention of asylum seekers, health access
Health Access Study	ScienceDirect Article	Examines asylum seeker health system
UPR Working Group 2017 Report	Refworld PDF	Document A/HRC/36/8

Unique Aspects of Finland's UNHRC Profile

1. **Children's asylum rights** are strongly referenced (CRC COs specifically call out best interests and bans on detaining minors) .
2. **Ukrainian refugee response** is robust, with detailed UNHCR support and integration programming.
3. **No asylum restrictions despite pressures**—UNHCR publicly warns Finland against unlawful limitations.
4. **Top-tier democratic freedoms**, scoring full marks in Freedom House evaluations.
5. **High treaty compliance**, with full engagement across key UN conventions .
6. **Health equity issues** identified for marginalized groups—referenced by both US reports and academic studies .
7. **Public transparency in UPR process**, highlighted by live UN Web TV access .
8. **Proactive UPR follow-up**, with archived mid-term and stakeholder contributions to ensure implementation .